

**Senate Armed Services Committee
Paper Hearing Questions
Hearing on 3/26/20, #20-20**

“To receive testimony on the posture of the Department of the Army in review of the Defense Authorization Request for Fiscal Year 2021 and the Future Years Defense Program.”

Witnesses: Secretary McCarthy, General McConville

Senator James M. Inhofe

Budget and Supporting the National Defense Strategy (NDS)

1. Secretary McCarthy, because the NDS Commission advocates 3 to 5 percent real growth per year to implement the NDS while the Fiscal Year 2021 Budget Request represents a \$15 billion reduction in purchasing power, where were you forced to assume risk?

Response: If there was the 3 to 5% real budget growth as recommended in the NDS in the FY21 topline, the Army would have been able to increase its investments in the critical legacy systems required to fight and win in the future against Russia or China. As there was a reduction in real buying power in FY21, the Army chose to fully fund our next generation modernization priorities at the cost of investing as we would have liked in those critical legacy platforms. For example, the Army reduced Joint Light Tactical Vehicle procurement by \$1.3B over the FYDP which results in HMMWV's being in formations longer than if we had 3 to 5% real budget growth. We also reduced investment in the Army Tactical Missile System Service Life Extension program by ~\$600M to shift resources to the Precision Strike Missile, which will replace the ATACMS round with enhanced performance. Additionally, the Army delayed procurement of the Enhanced Heavy Equipment Transporter (EHET) which means we'll be dependent on less capable heavy equipment movers for a longer period of time. In order to prioritize modernization investments, the Army assumed risk in endstrength by slowing the rate of growth toward our objective force endstrength levels. The Army must grow to both meet current combatant commander demand and resource the new structure required to fight and win in the future.

Readiness Concerns

2. General McConville, in the effort to meet NDS requirements, the Army successfully achieved in 2019 one of its stated 2023 readiness objectives by having 66 percent of regular Army BCTs [brigade combat teams] ready to “fight tonight,” allowing the Army to transition its focus from BCT readiness to “strategic readiness.” How does this budget invest in strategic readiness while also maintaining 66 percent of regular Army BCTs and their supporting elements at the right readiness levels?

Response: In FY21, Army will maintain its current tactical readiness levels and seek to improve its strategic readiness. The Army training focus at the tactical level is on building highly trained and cohesive teams that are disciplined and fit. We are increasing our focus on individual and small unit readiness. Home Station Training and Combat Training Center (CTC) rotation levels of effort are consistent with recent years that enabled Army to achieve and maintain readiness

goals. The Army FY21 budget request supports 24 CTC rotations and home station training IAW Army training strategy. The Army is seeking to improve its global posture at the strategic level by positioning formations and equipment (APS) in key strategic locations to deter adversaries and assure partners; investing in its Organic Industrial Base (OIB); improving mobilization through MFGI investments and exercises; building proficiency through repetition in deploying/redeploying operations with Dynamic Force Employment (DFE) and Emergency Deployment Readiness Exercises (EDREs), sustaining its generating and operating forces; aligning APS & LOGCAP to NDS priorities; and, investing in the industrial base.

Modernization Efforts (Fort Sill Focused)

3. Secretary McCarthy, because the U.S. Army's surface-to-surface fires are currently outranged and outgunned by many similar Russian and Chinese systems, the Long Range Precision Fires (LRPF) Cross Functional Team is working on programs to address these shortcomings. How will the Extended Range Cannon Artillery and the Precision Strike Missile (PrSM) programs help the joint force implement the NDS and regain a comparative advantage over Russian and Chinese competitors?

Response: The Extended Range Cannon Artillery (ERCA) system includes improving the self-propelled howitzer, projectiles, supercharge propellant, and course correcting fuzes for accurate fires at 70KM, almost twice the range of our current howitzers. These improvements will provide the division commander with a deep fires capability to shape the close fight in large scale combat operations, enabling combined arms overmatch. FY21 is an essential year to order long lead time parts to support final prototype development and building for delivery to the first battalion in FY23. ERCA Prototype 0 is assembled and executed a successful live fire demonstration on March 6th, achieving 65KM in range with target hits. We continue efforts to achieve the 70KM range.

The Precision Strike Missile (PrSM) is the Long Range Precision Fires Army modernization priority program to replace the Army Tactical Missile System (ATACMS). PrSM will be fired from existing launcher platforms with greater range, lethality, survivability, and at a lower cost than ATACMS. PrSM will allow the operational force to neutralize enemy integrated air defense systems and long range artillery to enable cross domain maneuver. The accelerated program delivers a base missile with a range greater than 500KM in FY23 (compared to the ATAMCS range of 160 KM), followed by technology spirals for emitting multi-domain targets, enhanced lethality, and extended range. PrSM has executed two successful flight tests since December, achieving target hits at 240KM and 180KM; the next flight test is planned for 30 April.

4. Secretary McCarthy, the Army currently lacks a reliable cruise missile defense capability which leaves the joint force vulnerable in some theaters. What is the Army's plan to defend against more advanced threats, such as hypersonic and supersonic cruise missiles, in the future?

Response: The best defense against hypersonic and supersonic cruise missiles is to have robust offensive and defensive capabilities. From an offensive perspective, we are placing significant